

— PHASE IV · PRESERVATION — A .LLAB™ WORKBOOK

.LLab Legacy Infrastructure Map™

Identify what should be captured, embedded, transferred, and sustained
— before it depends on memory.

PHASE
IV · Preservation

INVESTMENT
\$200

Everything valuable is currently living **somewhere fragile.**

Knowledge lives in one person's head. Relationships live in one person's contacts. Culture lives in habits nobody wrote down. Decision-making authority lives in whoever happens to be trusted right now. None of it is written to survive a departure, a leave of absence, an acquisition, or an ordinary Tuesday when the person who usually handles it is simply out sick.

Preservation isn't pessimism about the future — it's the recognition that anything worth building is worth making durable on purpose, instead of hoping it survives by accident.

THE CORE IDEA

Four verbs turn something fragile into something durable: **Capture** it, **Embed** it into how things run, **Transfer** it to more than one person, and design it to **Sustain** itself without your constant attention.

How to use this workbook

Work across four categories — Knowledge, Relationships, Culture, and Decision-Making Authority — and for each, apply the four verbs. You won't finish every cell today; the point is to see, clearly, where you currently have zero coverage.

Capture → Embed → Transfer → Sustain.

1 Capture — get it out of someone's head

Write it down. Record it. Document the reasoning, not just the conclusion. This is the lowest bar and the most frequently skipped — most organizations have never captured the thing they'd miss most if it disappeared.

2 Embed — build it into how things already run

A document nobody reads isn't preserved — it's archived. Embedding means it shows up inside a process people already follow: onboarding, a recurring review, a template that's actually used.

3 Transfer — put it in more than one set of hands

One successor is a single point of failure with a different name. Real transfer means at least two people could carry this forward, and both know it's their responsibility.

4 Sustain — make it self-renewing

The final test: does it require your ongoing attention to keep working, or does it now run on its own rhythm — reviewed, updated, and owned by the system rather than by you personally?

Map what needs to **survive**.

For each category, name the single most valuable — and most fragile — thing currently living there.

CATEGORY	WHAT'S MOST FRAGILE RIGHT NOW
Knowledge	
Relationships	
Culture	
Decision-Making Authority	

OF THOSE FOUR, WHICH ONE WOULD HURT THE MOST IF IT DISAPPEARED THIS YEAR?

WHERE IS IT TODAY ON THE CAPTURE → EMBED → TRANSFER → SUSTAIN PATH?

WHAT'S THE VERY NEXT STEP — CAPTURED BUT NOT EMBEDDED? EMBEDDED BUT NOT TRANSFERRED?

— CLOSING

Preservation is a **practice**, not an event.

This map is a snapshot. What it protects against changes constantly — new knowledge accumulates, new relationships form, culture keeps evolving. Revisit this quarterly, not once.

You don't preserve a legacy by hoping it survives you. You preserve it by building the infrastructure that carries it — deliberately, before you need it to.

Where this fits

The Legacy Infrastructure Map is a focused entry point into Phase IV — Preservation. For a comprehensive, scored assessment across all four phases at once, continue to the **.LLab Leadership Infrastructure Diagnostic™** — or, if you're ready to build the complete architecture, the **.LLab Legacy Infrastructure Architecture™** is the flagship framework this map feeds into.